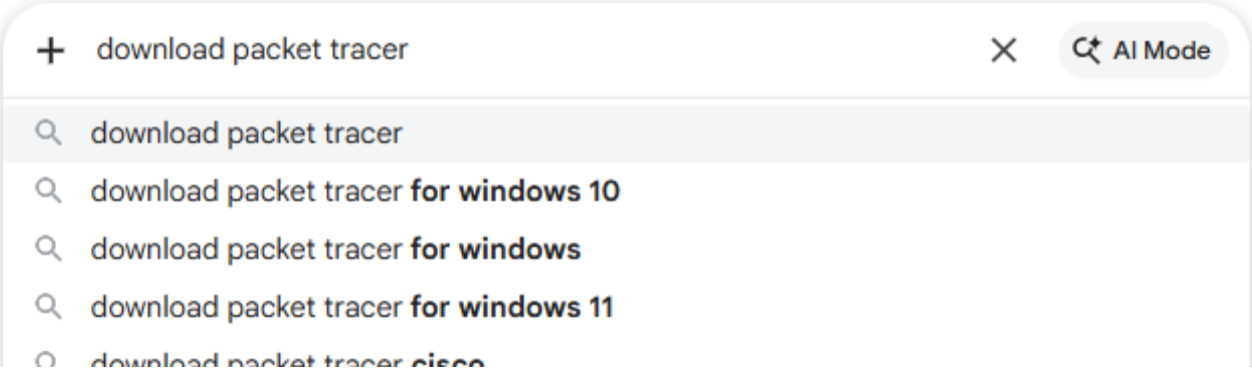
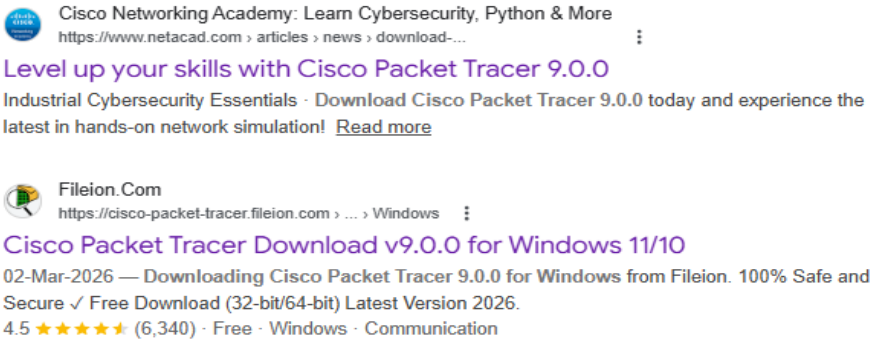
WEEK 1: Networking Fundamentals | Days: 1-7

Day 5 Tasks—Install packet tracer

- **TASK: Download and install Cisco Packet Tracer?**





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Cisco Packet Tracer

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Version	Compatibility	Language	Size	Last Updated
9.0.0	Windows 7 / Windows 8 / Windows 10 / Windows 11	English	287 MB	29, November 2025
8.2.2	Windows 7 / Windows 8 / Windows 10 / Windows 11	English	228 MB	29, August 2022
8.2.1	Windows 7.0 / Windows 8.1 / Windows 10 / Windows 11	English	227 MB	22, August 2022
8.2.0	Windows 7.0 / Windows 8.1 / Windows 10 / Windows 11	English	223 MB	18, August 2022
8.1.1	Windows 7.0 / Windows 8.1 / Windows 10 / Windows 11	English	222 MB	18, March 2022

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Cisco Packet Tracer 9.0.0 Download for Windows

You are about to download Cisco Packet Tracer, Version (9.0.0) for Windows.

Click the button below to start downloading it:

Start the Download

Not working? Report this App.

All you need to know about this download

- **Version:** 9.0.0
- **Last updated:** 02 March, 2026
- **Supported OS:** Windows 7 / Windows 8 / Windows 10 / Windows 11
- **File Name:** CiscoPacketTracer_900_win_64bit.exe
- **File Size:** 287 MB
- **File Hash Code:**

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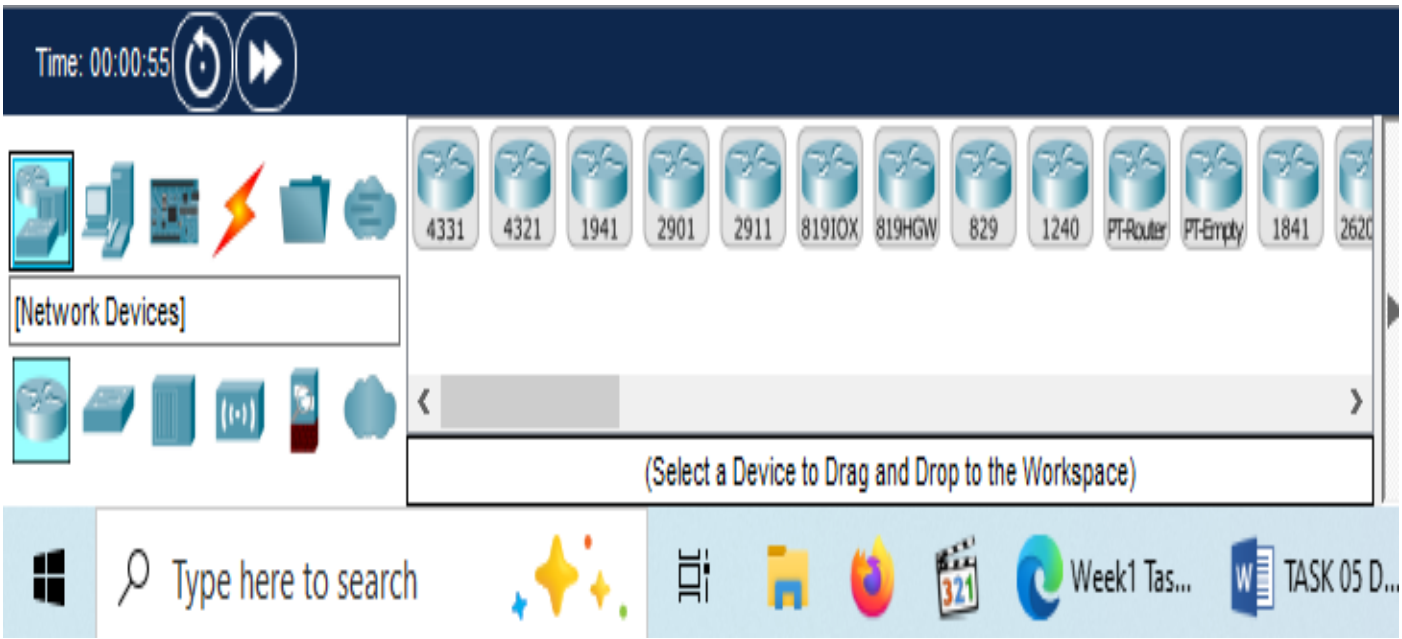
Install Packet Tracer

Steps:

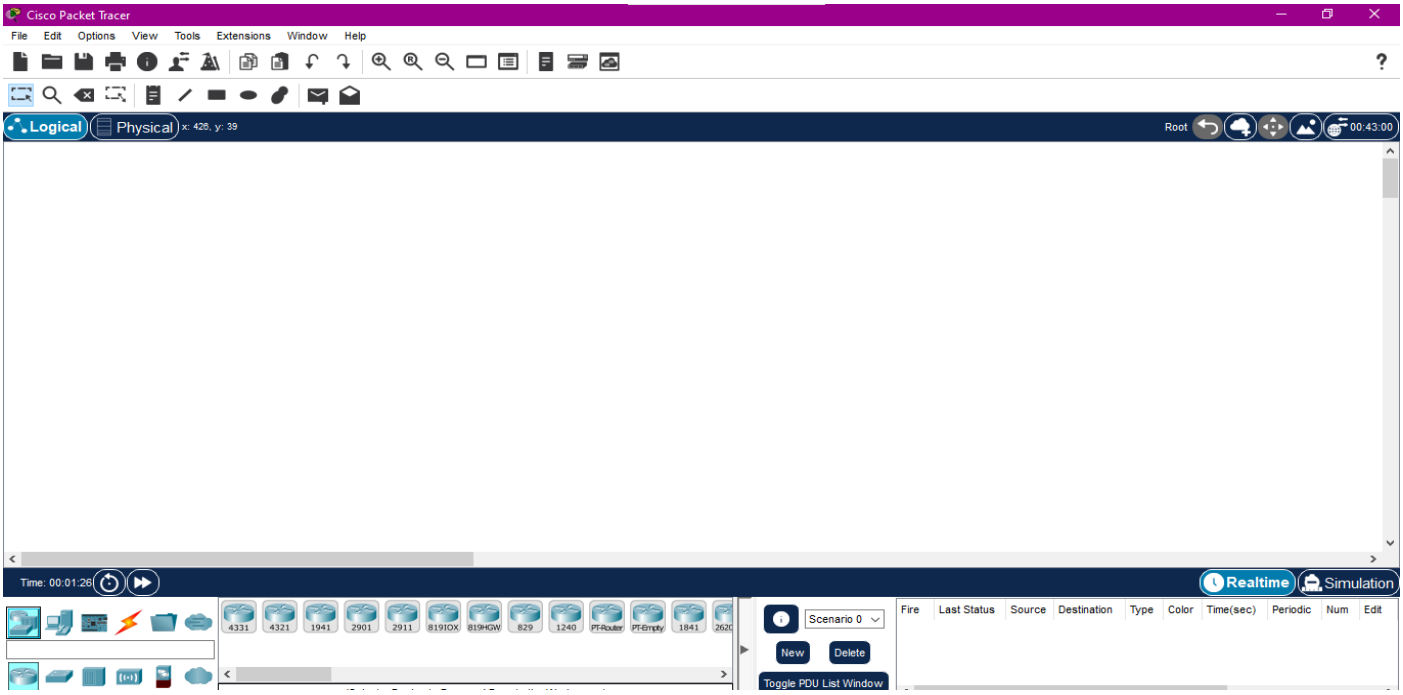
1. Download from Cisco NetAcad (free registration)
2. Install on Windows/Linux/Mac.

➢ TASK: Explore the interface: device panel, workspace, CLI?

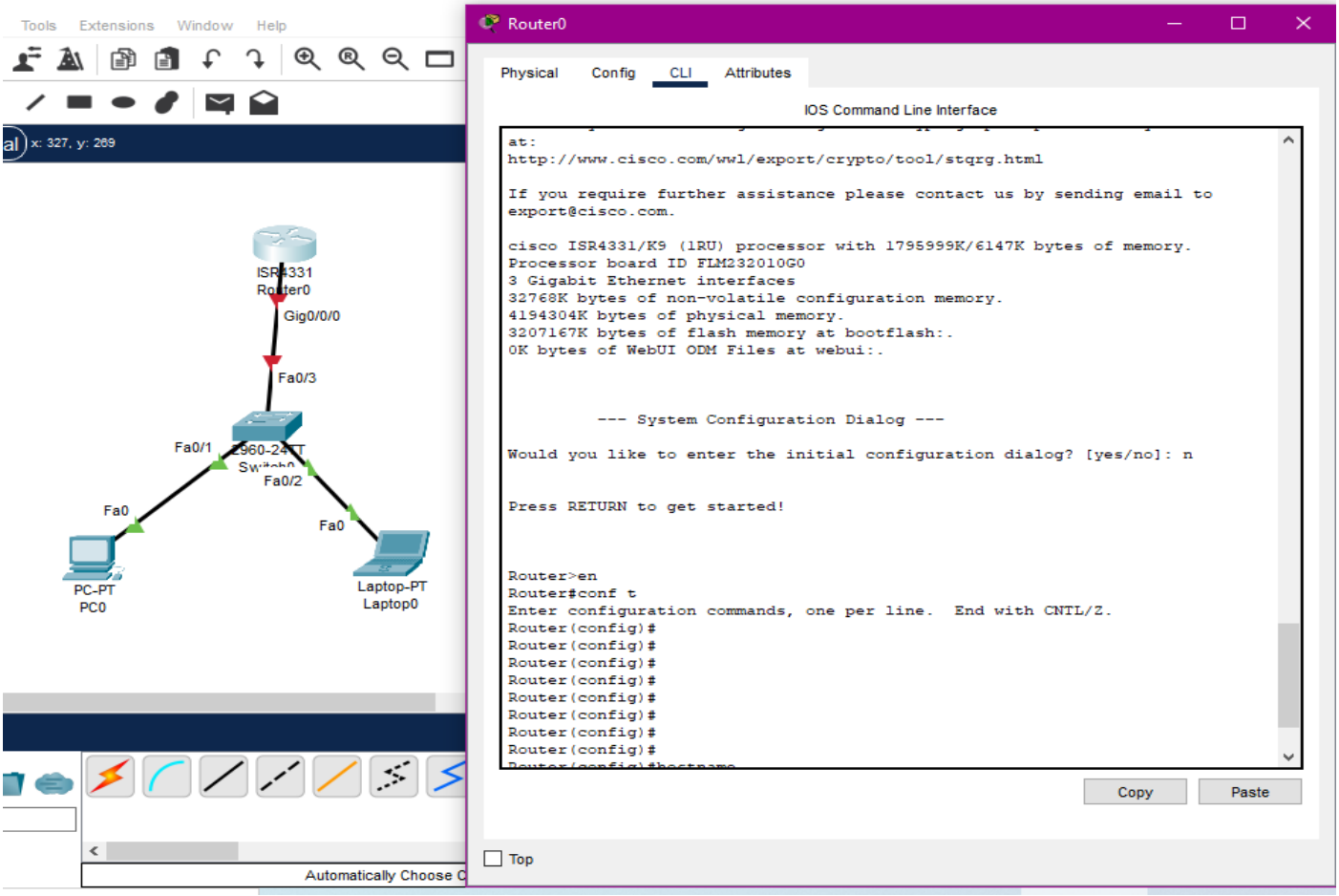
Device panel



Workspace



CLI



➢ TASK: Purpose and benefits of network simulation tools?

Virtualization revolutionized IT networking, making switches and routers almost as powerful as servers. It facilitates running containers and virtual machines directly on switches to maximize hardware utilization, streamline operations and enhance security.

Meanwhile, network simulation tools help IT engineers working in virtualized environments by providing a cost-effective and risk-free way to design, test and optimize networks before deployment in a production environment. They even help boost cybersecurity by enabling engineers to simulate threats, intrusion attempts, and disaster recovery scenarios to enhance network security and resilience.

So whether you work at a small business looking to optimize resources or a large enterprise seeking agility, virtualization offers a flexible solution to meet evolving IT demands. With the addition of network simulation platforms, even the smallest shops get change control to determine the behavior a networking alteration may have before it goes live.

Common Network Simulation Platforms

In this blog, we'll explore the benefits and drawbacks of some notable platforms that facilitate network design, experimentation and performance analysis. They include:

- **Eve-NG:** Known for its flexibility and support for a wide range of network devices.
- **Container Lab:** Offers container-based network labs, making it lightweight and efficient.
- **Cisco Modeling Labs (CML):** Provides a robust environment for simulating Cisco networks.
- **GNS3:** A well-known and user-friendly platform that supports a variety of network devices.

The Adaptability of Network Simulation Tools

Whether you're repurposing older hardware, leveraging newer systems, or deploying within existing virtualized environments, these network simulation platforms can be adapted to meet a wide range of needs. Here are a few additional points to consider about how each of these systems can integrate with physical hardware and virtualized environments.

Repurposing Older or Newer Hardware

Eve-NG, GNS3, Cisco Modeling Lab, and Container Lab can all run on various hardware configurations, from older machines with sufficient RAM and CPU resources to modern, high-performance systems. This makes them cost-effective solutions for many network engineers who want to set up their own lab environments.

Older Hardware: For example, a system with 16GB+ of RAM and a decent multi core processor can easily run multiple virtual devices using these platforms. If the hardware is only going to be used for light or small-scale labs, even a modest machine can work well.

Newer Hardware: More powerful systems can handle more complex topologies, advanced routing protocols, or virtualized instances of different network appliances. Additionally, with hardware advancements like faster SSDs and more cores, network engineers can emulate large-scale environments much faster and more efficiently.

Virtualization Support: Some older processors or motherboards may lack support for hardware virtualization, limiting the types of virtual machines that may be run.

Deployment in Existing Virtualized Environments

These platforms are often used in conjunction with virtualization technologies like VMware, Hyper-V, or KVM, enabling network engineers to deploy them in environments that are already virtualized. **VMware/Hyper-V:** Engineers can run Eve-NG, Cisco Modeling Lab, or GNS3 as virtual machines

themselves on a hypervisor, utilizing the existing virtualized infrastructure. This approach allows for easier resource management, better scalability, and more efficient use of physical resources.

KVM/Proxmox: These platforms can also be deployed within a KVM or Proxmox virtualized environment. In fact, some network engineers prefer Proxmox for its flexibility and ability to create containerized environments or virtual machines for lab setups.

Integration with Existing Hardware

Physical Device Integration: One of the key advantages of network virtualization is the ability to integrate virtual networks with actual hardware devices, making it more than just a virtualized setup. Both Eve-NG and GNS3, for example, allow you to connect virtual devices to physical devices like routers, switches, firewalls, or even wireless APs and phone systems.

For Example:

- **GNS3:** It supports integration with physical devices using tools like the GNS3 VM, which can connect virtual machines with real hardware via Ethernet interfaces. This allows you to create hybrid environments where virtual and physical devices work seamlessly together. You can even run network cables to real physical routers or switches and connect them to virtual routers or firewalls, enabling end-to-end testing.
- **Eve-NG:** Like GNS3, Eve-NG allows for connecting virtual devices to physical hardware, which can be useful when you want to simulate a live network environment and ensure configurations work on real devices before pushing them into production.

(The End)